

Hack The Web – Tedious Work II

There are ordinary patterns — and then there are numbers that simply belong together, like 1 and 99, even if they sit on two different ends of the calculation.

With an eye for patterns, you can quickly compute $1 + 2 + 3 + 4 + 5 + 95 + 96 + 97 + 98 + 99$.

In this challenge, we're told to do some math,
 $1 + 2 + 3 + 4 + 5 + 95 + 96 + 97 + 98 + 99$

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Manual Calculation - Grouping Sets

$$1 + 2 + 3 + 4 + 5 + 95 + 96 + 97 + 98 + 99$$

When performing manual calculation, it's useful to group sets of numbers that represent “round numbers”, e.g., $(1 + 99)$ or $(2 + 98)$, both of which add up to 100

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Manual Calculation - Grouping Sets

$$(1 + 99) (2 + 98) (3 + 97) (4 + 96) (5 + 95)$$

Since there are five sets of numbers which add up to 100, we can conclude that the answer to this equation is 500